

Word family: **hip / hips / hippy / hippie**

Base word: hip

Plural: hips

Related forms: hippy / hippie (historically related but now lexically distinct)

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / adjective (形容詞)

Your sentence:

> “For a few years, we were almost joined at the **hip**.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **hip** appears in the fixed expression **joined at the hip**.

Literally, the **hip** is the area at either side of the body where the upper leg joins the pelvis.

Figuratively, **joined at the hip** means two people are extremely close and spend so much time together that they seem inseparable.

繁體中文：** **hip 本義是髖部 / 臀胯部；joined at the hip 比喻兩個人關係非常親密，經常一起行動，幾乎形影不離**

中文翻譯：

> “For a few years, we were almost joined at the hip.”

「有好幾年的時間，我們幾乎可以說是**形影不離**。」

1. **hip = side of the body where the leg joins the pelvis (身體) — 髖部；臀胯部**

This is the central literal meaning.

Meaning: Either side of the body around the joint where the upper leg connects to the pelvis.

Practice 1

> “She put one hand on her **hip**.”

「她把一隻手放在**髖部 / 腰臀側**。」

Practice 2

> “He injured his **hip** in the fall.”

「他跌倒時弄傷了**髖部**。」

****hip** = 人體兩側、大腿與骨盆相接近的部位

Common:

- * hip joint
- * hip injury
- * hip pain
- * put your hands on your hips
- * hip replacement

2. ****hip** = fashionable / stylish / culturally current (非正式) — 時髦的 ; 新潮的

As an informal adjective, ****hip**** can mean fashionable, modern, or attractive according to current cultural trends.

Practice 3

> “The neighbourhood has become a ****hip**** place for young artists.”

「這個社區已成為年輕藝術家喜愛的****時髦 / 新潮****地方。」

Practice 4

> “They opened a ****hip**** little café near the station.”

「他們在車站附近開了一間很****時髦有型****的小咖啡店。」

****hip** = 符合當代潮流、具有時尚或文化吸引力的 ; 非正式

This is genuinely different from the anatomical noun.

3. ****hip** = aware of current ideas/culture (非正式 , 較舊) — 熟悉潮流的 ; 懂行的

Historically and in some continuing informal use, ****hip**** can mean knowledgeable about what is currently happening, especially in music, culture, fashion, or a particular scene.

Practice 5

> “He likes to think he is ****hip**** to the latest trends.”

「他喜歡認為自己很**了解最新潮流**。」

Practice 6

> “She was already **hip** to what was happening in the local music scene.”

「她早已**很熟悉 / 很了解**本地音樂圈正在發生的事情。」

****be hip to something = 熟悉、了解或意識到某件當代文化 / 圈內事情****

For a modern learner database, I would keep this as a ****secondary informal extension**** of Meaning 2 rather than a separate high-priority core sense.

4. ****hip = fruit of a rose (植物) — 薔薇果 ; 玫瑰果****

A ****hip****, especially ****rose hip****, is the small fruit that develops on a rose plant after flowering.

Practice 7

> “Rose ****hips**** often turn red or orange in autumn.”

「****薔薇果 / 玫瑰果****在秋天通常會變成紅色或橙色。」

Practice 8

> “The tea is made from dried rose ****hips****.”

「這種茶是用乾燥的****玫瑰果****製成的。」

****hip = 玫瑰或薔薇植物開花後形成的果實****

This is a genuinely distinct botanical noun meaning, although less common than the body meaning.

Target expression: ****joined at the hip — 形影不離****

This is the exact use in your passage.

Literally, the image suggests two people whose hips are physically attached.

Figuratively:

****joined at the hip** = two people are extremely close, spend nearly all their time together, or are rarely seen apart******

Practice 9 — Original

> “For a few years, we were almost ****joined at the hip****.”

「有好幾年的時間，我們幾乎****形影不離****。」

Practice 10

> “The sisters were ****joined at the hip**** when they were children.”

「那對姊妹小時候總是****形影不離****。」

****joined at the hip** = 兩個人關係非常親密，經常一起出現或行動，幾乎不分開******

This is an idiom built from the anatomical sense of ****hip****, not a separate core lexical meaning of ****hip**** itself.

Useful expression: ****shoot from the hip** — 未充分思考便迅速反應 / 發言******

This expression originally evokes acting quickly without carefully aiming.

Practice 11

> “He tends to ****shoot from the hip**** instead of thinking carefully first.”

「他往往會****未經深思便直接作出反應****。」

Practice 12

> “Try not to ****shoot from the hip**** when answering difficult questions.”

「回答困難問題時，盡量不要****未經思考便衝口而出****。」

****shoot from the hip** = 沒有充分準備或思考便迅速說話、判斷或採取行動******

This is a fixed idiom rather than a new sense of bare ****hip****.

Useful expression: ****on your hip** / carry something on your hip******

Practice 13

> “She carried the child on her **hip**.”

「她把孩子抱在**腰臀側 / 髖部**。」

Practice 14

> “He rested the box against his **hip**.”

「他把箱子靠在自己的**髖部**。」

These simply belong to the anatomical meaning.

Important distinction: **hip vs waist**

hip

= the area where the upper leg joins the pelvis, lower and more lateral

waist

= the narrower part of the torso between the ribs and hips

So:

hip = 髖部 / 臀胯部

waist = 腰部

They are adjacent but anatomically different.

Important distinction: **hip vs pelvis**

hip

can refer to the external body area and the joint where the leg meets the pelvis.

pelvis

refers more specifically to the bony structure at the base of the torso.

So **hip** is the more ordinary everyday body word.

Important distinction: **hip** vs **fashionable**

hip

is informal and often carries a youthful/cultural sense:

> a hip café

fashionable

is broader and more neutral:

> fashionable clothes

So:

hip = 新潮、有型、文化上走在潮流前端的

fashionable = 流行的；合時尚的

Important distinction: **hip** vs **cool**

Both can mean socially attractive or fashionable.

hip

often emphasizes:

- * current culture
- * style
- * trend awareness

cool

is broader and can mean:

- * fashionable
- * impressive
- * admirable
- * relaxed

> “a hip neighbourhood”

strongly suggests a fashionable cultural scene.

> “a cool neighbourhood”

is broader and more conversational.

Related form note: **hippie / hippy**

Hippie (also spelled **hippy**) refers to a member of the countercultural movement associated especially with the 1960s and 1970s, or more loosely someone associated with a similar alternative lifestyle.

Practice 15

> “The photograph shows young **hippies** at a music festival.”

「照片中是音樂節上的年輕**嬉皮士**。」

This word is historically connected to **hip**, but modern learners should treat **hippie** as its own lexical item rather than as a transparent grammatical form of **hip**.

The Golden Manual's family sweep allows useful lexical relatives to be included, but they should be accurately labelled rather than falsely presented as additional meanings of the base word.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning	
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hip — body part	人體兩側、大腿與骨盆相接近附近的髖部 / 臀胯部	
hip — fashionable	符合當代潮流、具有時尚或文化吸引力的；非正式	
hip to something	熟悉、了解或意識到某種潮流或情況；較舊 / 非正式，與 fashionable/aware 義相關	
hip — rose fruit	玫瑰或薔薇開花後形成的果實；薔薇果 / 玫瑰果	
joined at the hip	兩個人關係非常親密，經常一起行動，幾乎形影不離	
shoot from the hip	未經充分準備或思考便迅速說話、判斷或行動	

For your original sentence

> “For a few years, we were almost **joined at the hip**.”

The literal base meaning is:

****hip = 人體大腿與骨盆相接附近的髖部****

But the whole expression means:

****joined at the hip = 關係非常親密，幾乎總是在一起，形影不離****

So the sentence means:

> ****有好幾年的時間，我們幾乎形影不離。****

For your database, I would count ****3 genuinely useful core meanings**** for ****hip****:

1. ****the body part where the upper leg joins the pelvis****
2. ****informal adjective — fashionable / culturally current****
3. ****the fruit of a rose plant****

I would merge ****be hip to something**** into #2 as a related older ****aware/in-the-know**** extension, and keep ****joined at the hip**** and ****shoot from the hip**** as fixed expressions rather than inflate the core count.